

that of Babylon was had in the Bible itself. Several prophetic oracles had announced the coming destruction of Babylon by the Medes—doubtless a true reflex of the triumph of the Umman-Manda over Nineveh—and this expectation affected the Jewish retrospection. Such passages are Is. 13¹⁷, 21², Jer. 51^{11, 27-29} (*n.b.*, 'the kings of the Medes').

There is one ancient and very respectable reason why the Fourth Monarchy has been sought in Rome. With the putting off of the fulfilment of the Apocalyptic expectation of the consummation of the Kingdom of God, interpretation simply proceeded to keep the prophecy up to date. Accordingly the Jews under Rome found that Monarchy in their new mistress, *teste* Josephus; and this ruling Jewish interpretation was naturally carried over by the Church with its vivid eschatological hopes. Subsequently the Jewish comm. found that Monarchy in Islam, and in the same spirit Protestant theologians were content to work out the fulfilment of prophecy through the Middle Ages down to their own day (the feet and toes of the Image were German states and what-not), and the Papacy could be identified with the Antichrist.⁶ But the early Christian exegesis followed the Jewish interpretation in finding the desecration of the sanctuary, end of c. 9, in the Roman destruction of Jerusalem, an interpretation followed by Jesus himself in expecting the future setting up of the 'Abomination of Desolation'; it was only subsequently, with the rise of Christian historical scholarship that the chronologers came to devote themselves to the task of reading the mystery of the 490 years, and to find it cul-

to the ground such an assertion as is made by Wilson, p. 147: "It will be perfectly evident that all educated men living in and before the second century B.C. must have had access to so much information with regard to the number and history of the Babylonian and Persian kings, as to render it highly improbable that any writer of the second century B.C. could have been as ignorant of the history of Persia as certain critics represent the writer of Daniel to have been." If the author of Dan. had read the Gr. historians he would have been corroborated in the scheme of successive monarchies he here presents—which shows that his lack of historical knowledge does not prove him to have been an unlearned and foolish writer. For the still obscure subject of the Median kingdom, or rather kingdoms, s. Justi in Geiger and Kuhn's *Grundriss d. iran. Philologie*, 2, 406-413; Winckler, *KAT* 104 f.; and the brief *Outline of Pers. History Based on the Cuneiform Inscriptions*, 1922, by Ahl. Supplementarily there is to be added the valuable discussion by Forrer, *ZDMG* 76 (1922), 247, acc. to which Manda = Madai can be traced back in Akk. and Hittite documents to the reign of Naram-Sin.

⁶ This latter identification still figures in Boutflower's presentation of 'The Roman Scheme,' p. 14, where the Little Horn = the temporal power of the Papacy!

minating somewhere in the history of the first-century Christian Church. On the history of this interpretation s. the Note at end of c. 9 and also that after c. 2. It is a vast mistake that has been perpetrated, especially by Protestant theologians in their disregard of the history of exegesis, to hold that the identification of the lower term of the 490 years with the epoch of Jesus Christ has always been the 'Christian' exegesis. This is false to the fact of the great variety of Christian interpretation.

d. Darius the Mede.

How then can we identify Darius the Mede? Such is his designation, and he was 62 years old, according to 6¹⁽²⁾. 9¹ makes him 'son of Xerxes, of the seed of the Medes,' who succeeded as king over the kingdom of the Chaldæans.⁷ In the Bible we learn of four Persian kings: Cyrus, *e.g.*, Ezr. 1; Artaxerxes, 4⁷; Darius 4⁵, 5^{6ff.}, probably Darius the Persian, Neh. 12²²—so the actual order in Ezr.-Neh.; and Xerxes, Est. 1, etc. Likewise according to Dan 11² there were four Pers. kings, *cf.* the 'four heads' of the symbolic beast 7⁶. This abbreviation of the length of the Persian empire has its counterpart in the later Jewish reckoning of but 34 years to the Pers. *régime*; s. Note on the Interpretation of the 70 Weeks, end of c. 9, *sub* (3). Our Darius the Mede is evidently distinguished from Darius the Persian. Boutflower, p. 143, notes six identifications that have been proposed for the Mede, two of them of recent origin. One of the elder identifications (s. Dr., p. liii) is Astyages, the Median king conquered by Cyrus, whom the latter is gratuitously supposed to have installed as viceroy in Babylon; another Cyaxares (II), who, according to Xenophon's *Cyropaedia*, viii, 5, 8, married his daughter to Cyrus; but according to i, 2, 1, Cyrus married a daughter of Astyages. We see how little confidence we can place upon Xenophon's romance. This lightness of later tradition is carried on by Josephus, who states, *AJ* x, 11, 4, that this Darius "with his kinsman Cyrus put an end to the dominion of Babylon; he was the son of Astyages (acc. to Dan., of Xerxes!), and had another name among the Greeks."

⁷ There is nothing cryptic in the expressions translated 'received the kingdom,' 6¹, and 'was made king,' 9¹, *v. ad locc.*; this against those who hold to indications that Darius was only a viceroy.

One recent identification is that with Cambyses, on the ground that the latter appears to have enjoyed the title of king from the beginning of Cyrus' reign; this was proposed by Winckler, *KAT* 287, and has been warmly adopted by Boufflower, p. 145. But no explanation of the equation 'Darius the Mede = Cambyses the Persian' is offered, and Boufflower appeals in vain (pp. 153 ff.) to a hypothesis that the Pers. names were epithetical, titular.

The more popular recent identification is that with Gubaru, Cyrus' lieutenant, who made the actual entry into Babylon in the name of his master, and subsequently was governor of that province according to the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle. Other texts have since come to light which indicate that Gubaru was a high officer under Neb., probably toward the end of his reign; that under Cambyses he was governor both of Babylon and Abar-Nahara ('Across-Euphrates'). He appears also in the Behistûn Inscription as one of Darius I's field-m Marshals. Herodotus makes frequent reference to him in the history of Darius, and Xenophon gives extensive notices of him in the *Cyropaedia* (as Gobryas). This material has now been assembled and amply discussed by W. Schwenzner, who presents a plausible and most romantic reconstruction of the history of this Persian magnate, who probably as a mercenary enjoyed high rank under Neb., who appears to have made defection from Nabonidus (of the anti-Nebuchadnezzar party) and gone over to Cyrus, then received his high commands in the new empire, and subsequently became one of Darius' doughty lieutenants in the establishment of his kingdom.⁸

But 'Darius = Gubaru,' as far as names go, is still as fallacious an equation as is 'Darius = Cambyses'; such attempts are no bet-

⁸ W. Schwenzner, 'Gobryas,' *Klio*, 18 (1922), 41-58, 226-252. The texts in their chronological order appear: in Scheil, *Rev. d'ass.* 11 (1914), 165 ff., a text indicating that Gubaru held high rank under Neb. (so Scheil and Schwenzner, but Clay, *JAOS* 41, 466 argues that the date is under Cyrus); in the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle (for literature s. note 12 below), acc. to which 'Gubaru, governor of Gutium, and the soldiers of Cyrus entered Babylon without a battle,' and after Cyrus' entry into the city and proclamation of peace 'he appointed Gubaru his satrap and prefects also in Babylon'; in Nies and Keiser, *Bab. Inscriptions in the Collection of James B. Nies*, pt. 2, 1918, nos. 69 and 114, of Cambyses' accession year, in both of which transgression against the terms of the documents involves 'sin against Gubaru, governor (*bêl pihati*) of Babylon and of Abar-Nahara (*ebir nari*)'; in Clay (not the editor, Hilprecht), *BE* viii, 1, no. 80, of Cambyses' 1st year, recording a 'canal of Gubaru'; in Strassmaier, *Inscripfen v. Cambyfes*, no. 96, relating to his private affairs, barns,

ter than those of 6 and Josephus to rectify the order of Pers. kings in the later bks. of the O.T. The Behistûn Inscr. knows Gubaru as a Persian, against Wilson's vain attempts to prove the possibility of his being a Mede. Further, the more we know of Gobryas the less can we assign him royal rank. It is well-nigh impossible that a highest noble could have been given the title even popularly, still less by a member of the Pers. court, as the seer Daniel is alleged to have been. Such a title could have been nothing less than high treason, involving the subject as well as the writer. But the Biblical Darius the Mede acts as omnipotent autocrat over a vast empire of 120 satrapies,⁹ and the *ne plus ultra* of royal autocracy appears in the edict he signs that none should worship any god or man but himself. Neither Gobryas nor Cambyases, in his father's lifetime, could have perpetrated such an absurdity. For explanation of the story we can only make surmises. For local reasons not known to us the great Darius I, who made Cyrus' domain into an organized empire, who had to punish Babylon for its rebelliousness in his early days, may have passed as a Mede, and there being no place for him in the line of the four Pers. kings known to the Bible, may have been made the representative of the supposititious Median kingdom and so been placed before Cyrus. In him the captures of Babylon by Gobryas and Darius I may have been compounded, and in so far we may have a residuum of tradition.¹⁰

etc.; in Pinches, *PSBA* 38 (1916), 29 f., of Cambyases' 4th year, similar to the Nies texts (the title of governorship of Abar-Nahara is omitted). In the Behistûn Inscr. there is ref. to Gubaru-Gaubaruua, in §68 in trilingual form, in §71 in OPers. alone, Gubaru being termed 'son of Mardonia, a Persian,' and appearing as one of Darius' field-marsals (s. Weissbach, 'Die Keilinschriften d. Achämeniden,' in *Vorderas. Bibliothek*). Gobryas appears as a leading personage in Herodotus for the events in Darius I's reign (iii, 70, etc.), while he figures largely in Xenophon's *Cyrus Romance*, the *Cyropaedia*. Below in sub-section (e) will be given a summary of the story told in viii, 5, of his seizure of the palace in Babylon and the killing of the Bab. king; most of the anecdotes about Gobryas concern his relations with Darius. The historical value of these Gr. traditions is fully discussed by Schwenzner. See also for an earlier discussion C. F. Lehmann-Haupt, 'Gobryas u. Belsazar bei Xenophon,' *Klio*, 1902, 341-5.

⁹ Technically a woful exaggeration, excusable only from the later degenerated use of 'satrap'; s. at 3^d.

¹⁰ Cf. Behrmann, p. xix, Dr., p. liv, Cornill, *Int.*, 258, against which line of argument cf. Wilson, cc. 10-12. Cambyases' acts of sacrilege in Egypt may have given rise to this fable of royal claim of deity, yet Darius appears in the story as a friendly character. But the theme belonged to the common satire of Jewish story; acc. to Judith 3^d Neb. gave an edict that he alone should be worshipped.

e. *Belshazzar*.

The existence of a Belshazzar at the end of the Chaldaean dynasty was strikingly demonstrated by the discovery of his name on the Nabonidus Cylinder, in which he appears as Nabonidus' son.¹¹ Otherwise Belsh. had entirely disappeared from history except for the reff. in Dan. and the dependent ref. in Bar. 1¹¹, where the Jews are bidden to 'pray for the life of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and for the life of Baltasar his son,' which appears at first sight to be an echo of Dan. A large number of cuneiform references have since been discovered. The following treatment concerns itself only with the main facts and their interpretation.¹²

In the cuneiform texts Belsh. is called either by his name or, as in the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle simply 'son of the king,' *i.e.*, *anglice*, 'crown prince.' In the Chronicle for years 7, 9, 10, 11 of Nabonidus' reign it is recorded that "the king was in Teima; the son of the king, the princes and his (or, the) army were in the land of Akkad." In the texts hitherto known Belsh. is never given the title of king, and this has been ground for argument against one detail of our story which represents Belsh. as absolute king. But Sidney Smith's presentation of a new text (s. end of Note 12) shows that royal dignity was actually con-

¹¹ Cf. for the first discoveries *COT* 2, 130.

¹² The writer is deeply indebted to Prof. R. P. Dougherty, late of Goucher College, now of Yale, for his generosity in affording him the full use of his materials for a forthcoming volume entitled *Nabonidus and Belshazzar*, in the Yale Oriental Series. Only as this volume was being finally prepared for the press did the ms copy of Dr. Dougherty's volume come to hand. The data here presented, as, indeed, all the earlier studies, will be much antiquated by Dr. Dougherty's exhaustive volume. But it seems wise to the writer to leave his study in its present state with the presentation of his conclusions as already reached, while referring the reader to that forthcoming volume.

For the literature used here I note the following: Rogers, *Cuneiform Inscr. and the O.T.*, 378 ff., and *KAT* vol. 3, give the Nabonidus Cylinder already mentioned, as also the Cyrus Cylinder celebrating his conquest of Babylon; these also appear in Barton, *Archæology and the Bible*, c. 20, along with the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle, first published by Pinches, *PSBA* 1882, 167 ff. Recently published reff. to Belsh. are those of Pinches, *PSBA* 1916, 27 ff.; Clay, *Miscell. Inscr. in the Yale Bab. Collection*, 1915, no. 39; Dougherty, *Records from Erech, Time of Nabonidus* (Yale Or. Series), 1920, no. 134, and *Archives from Erech, Time of Nebuch. and Nab.* (Goucher College), 1923, no. 204. For successive presentations of the material s. Pinches, *O.T. in the Light of the Hist. Records of Ass. and Bab.*, 1903, c. 12; Wright, c. 4; Wilson, c. 6; Boutflower, c. 11. Finally, a new text of Nab. describing his conquest of Arabian Teima has been published by Sidney Smith, *Bab. Hist. Texts*, 1924, 84 ff.

ferred upon Belsh. This text, of the third full year of Nabonidus, detailing that king's victorious campaign against Arabian Teima (as this place has elsewhere been identified by Dougherty), records: "He intrusted a camp to his eldest, his first-born son; the troops of the land he sent with him. He freed his hand; he intrusted the kingship (*šarrûlam*) to him." That is, in the early part of Nabonidus' reign, in his third year, his son was invested with royal dignity, which, in view of the active position he held throughout the subsequent years, must have continued throughout his life. That is, the Bible story is correct as to the rank of kingship given to Belsh. Now in several texts the prince's name is coupled with his father's in the latter's prayers and in the omens interpreted for him; and in Pinches' text and two texts in the Yale Museum his name is associated with his father's in an oath; on which Dougherty remarks: "There is no other instance in available documents of an oath being sworn in the name of the son of the king." The induction therefore that had been made from earlier data by Pinches, Dougherty, and others, is now brilliantly corroborated; as in a previous statement of the latter scholar: "It appears that he was invested with a degree of royal authority, not only at the close of the reign of his father, but throughout large part, if not the whole, of the reign of Nabonidus."

For the capture of Babylon, the fall of Nabonidus and the disappearance of Belsh. from history, the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle is our immediate authority. The following translation is taken from Dougherty: "In the month Tishri,^{12a} when Cyrus fought at Opis on the Tigris river against the troops of Akkad, he destroyed the people with burning; he put the people to death. On the 14th day Sippar was captured without fighting. Nabonidus fled. On the 16th day Ugbaru the governor of Gutium, and the troops of Cyrus entered Babylon without fighting. Afterward, when Nabonidus returned, he was taken captive in Babylon. Until the end of the month the arms of Gutium surrounded the gates of the temple Esagila. No one's weapon was placed in Esagila or the sanctuaries, and no appointed time was disregarded. In the month Marchesvan, the 3d day, Cyrus

^{12a} E. Meyer, *ZATW* 1898, 339 ff., corrected 'Tammuz' to 'Tishri,' as the sequence of events demands; Dougherty reads 'Tishri' without comment.

entered Babylon. *Harine* (?) were carried before him. Prosperity was established in the city; Cyrus decreed prosperity for all in Babylon. Gobryas, his governor, placed governors in charge of Babylon. From Kislev to Adar the gods of Akkad, whom Nabonidus had brought up to Babylon, they returned to their cities." There follow, as Dougherty notes, the death of a prominent personage and a period of mourning, in the following fragmentary lines: "In the month Marchesvan, on the night of the 11th, Ugbaru . . . In the month (?) the . . . of the king died. From the 28th day of Adar to the third day of Nisan there was weeping in the land of Akkad. . . . All the people prostrated their heads." Who this personage was is quite doubtful; most scholars, while recognizing the uncertainty, have filled the lacuna with 'the son [of the king],' *i.e.*, Belsh.; so, *e.g.*, King, Barton, Clay, Bouffflower (p. 129), and Dougherty earlier; but the latter now does not venture to fill the gap. He writes later on: "Accurate interpretation . . . is impossible owing to the illegible condition of the text. However, there is strong probability that Belsh. was slain in connection with the fall of Babylon, as indicated in the fifth chapter of Daniel and intimated by the record of Xenophon." On this point the writer admires Dougherty's candid scepticism, for he himself must enter a demurrer against the theory that the conqueror's own record could have so distinguished the death of a prince who was, when free and alive, a hopeless rebel.

How and where Belsh. came to his end we do not learn from the Akk. documents. But some Gr. data, which have often been alleged as history, must be considered. Herodotus, i, 191, describes at length Cyrus' capture of Babylon. According to his story the city had been stoutly fortified and provisioned against Cyrus' attack. But the latter diverted the Euphrates into a great basin, which had been made by Neb.'s queen Nitocris when she was building the water-walls of the city; and by this dry channel he entered the city unawares (by night?—although this is not stated), "as they were engaged in a festival, dancing and revelling until they learned of the capture but too surely." The story is paralleled by a much longer narrative in Xenophon's *Cyropaedia*, vii, 5 (noticed above under the title 'Darius the Mede'). Cyrus formed the plan of draining off the river into a trench which he had dug; he drained off the waters on a night

when "he heard that there was a festival in Babylon, in which all the Babylonians drank and revelled the whole night." The attacking party was headed by Cyrus, with his officers Gadatas and Gobryas acting as guides. They entered the city, taking advantage of the revelry in the streets, and easily reached the palace. They entered and found the king standing with his sword drawn; he was made away with by Gadatas and Gobryas and their party, and then ensued a massacre of those found in the streets. Soon after Cyrus held a public reception and entered into the palace.

Certain parallels with the story in Dan. 5 are obvious and interesting, and the reconstruction often made is that this unnamed king of the *Cyropaedia* is Belshazzar, that he was functioning as king, even without the actual name, and that Gobryas who killed him is Darius the Mede, the Gubaru of the Bab. records.

On these stories it is to be remarked that historians now universally reject the tradition of a forcible capture of Babylon in view of the plain record of the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle that Cyrus' troops under Gubaru peacefully occupied the city and captured Nabonidus in it, he himself celebrating his triumph a little later. Furthermore we have the account of Berossus preserved by Josephus, *C. Apionem*, i, 20, which varies somewhat from the official records but gives no room for a 'king Belshazzar.' We read: "When Nabonnedus perceived that Cyrus was coming to attack him, he met him with his forces, and, joining battle with him, was beaten and fled away with a few of his troops, and was shut up within the city Borsippa. Hereupon Cyrus took Babylon and gave order that the outer walls of the city should be demolished, because the city had proved very troublesome to him, and cost him great pains to take it. He then marched away to Borsippa to besiege Nabonnedus; but as Nabonnedus did not sustain the siege, but delivered himself into his hands, he was at first kindly treated by Cyrus, who gave him Carmania as a place for him to inhabit and sent him out of Babylonia." It is to be noticed that there are variations from the Chronicle, especially in regard to the resistance put up by Nabonidus and the difficulty of taking the city promptly. It must be borne in mind that Berossus himself is a witness 240 years after the events he narrates, although withal a much

more reliable authority than the earlier Herodotus and Xenophon.¹³

There remains, however, but only after Xenophon's Romance, the death of an unnamed king of Babylon in his palace on a night of revelry at the hands of two Persian officers, one of them Gobryas, doubtless a reminiscence of the historical Gubaru. That the unfortunate Belsh., abandoned by his father in his chivalrous resistance to the conqueror, should have been popularly called king by his faithful subjects is not impossible, and, as Lehmann-Haupt remarks, in note 8, he would have passed in native tradition as the last Bab. king. Nor, it must be allowed, would the Chronicle, edited by the new administration, have granted him that title even if he had actually assumed it, as Cyrus regarded himself as the legitimate successor of Nabonidus.¹⁴ But whether a Jewish writer, contemporaneous with the conqueror and one of his court, would have desired or dared to use the title 'king' of the prince Belshazzar, whom the Pers. dynasty could only have regarded as a rebellious upstart, is a matter for serious deliberation for those who must pass upon the historicity of the Biblical story.

Yet other data are given in Dan. 5 which have a bearing upon our investigation. The 'Queen,' recognized by all to be the queen-mother, enters the banquet-hall to bid her son call in the sage Daniel, who 'in the days of king Neb. thy father had been made by him master-magician.' What is to be said about this asserted paternity of Nebuchadnezzar? And can we identify the lady?

In the foundation cylinder of Nabonidus, already cited and existing in duplicate (*KB* 3, 96) Belsh. is spoken of as 'the first son proceeding from my heart' (*libbia*). Wilson, pp. 117-122, considers at length 'the possibility of a man having two fathers.' After an excursus on the vague use of 'son' in Oriental languages, he presents eight different ways in which Belsh. may have been called 'son' of Neb.¹⁵ *E.g.*, he may have been Neb.'s

¹³ A longer account by Berossus of the Chaldean empire has been preserved in the Armenian Chronicle of Eusebius, first published by Mai; s. C. Müller, *Fragm. hist. graec.*, 2, 504. Berossus' narratives appear to be generally ignored by the apologists for c. 5.

¹⁴ See the arguments by Wilson, c. 5, 'The Use of the Word "King."'

¹⁵ He gives as an instance of the ideal or spiritual use of 'offspring of my heart' the application of that term to Nabonidus by the high priest of Harran.